

Terms and Conditions for Participation

PUSHPAK Grand Challenge 2026

“Host Institute” means the Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay), being the Host of the PUSHPAK Grand Challenge 2026.

“Collaborating institutes” means Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Bhopal (IISERB) and Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute (VJTI), being the institutes collaborating with IIT Bombay.

Host and the Collaborating Institutes are jointly organizing the PUSHPAK Grand Challenge 2026 with the Techfest of IIT Bombay.

By registering for or participating in the PUSHPAK Grand Challenge 2026 ("Challenge"), each participant agrees to comply with these Terms and Conditions, the applicable Problem Statement, and any official instructions or clarifications issued by the organizers.

1. Eligibility and Registration

1. Participation is open to eligible individuals and entities specified in the relevant problem statement.
2. Teams may consist of up to five members, unless otherwise specified for a particular Challenge.
3. Participants shall provide complete and accurate information during registration. The organizers may request supporting documents to verify eligibility or affiliation.
4. Each team shall designate a Team Lead or primary contact for official communication.
5. Any material change in team composition after registration shall be communicated to and, will always be required to be approved by the organizers.

2. Compliance with Challenge Requirements

1. Participants shall comply with the requirements, submission formats, deadlines, technical conditions, and evaluation criteria specified in the applicable Problem Statement and official Challenge communications.
2. Participants are responsible for ensuring that their submissions are complete, readable, and submitted within the prescribed deadline.
3. Late, incomplete, inaccessible, or materially non-compliant submissions may not be considered.
4. The organizers may request clarifications, supporting technical evidence, source files, simulation files, logs, code, demonstrations, or other information reasonably required to verify a submission.

3. Authenticity and Responsibility for Submissions

1. Participants are responsible for the accuracy, authenticity, and technical validity of their submissions.
2. Participants shall not knowingly:
 - plagiarize or misrepresent third-party work as their own;
 - fabricate or falsify data, results, simulations, demonstrations, or performance claims;
 - conceal material third-party contributions; or
 - submit material that they are not authorized to use.
3. Participants remain responsible for verifying any design, analysis, software, code, or content generated using computational, AI-based, or other automated tools.
4. Participants may be required to explain, defend, reproduce, or demonstrate their work during evaluation.

4. Third-Party Tools, Software, and Materials

1. Participants may use licensed third-party software, open-source tools, datasets, libraries, models, components, or other resources where permitted by the applicable Problem Statement.
2. Participants shall ensure that they possess the necessary rights, licences, permissions, or authorizations for any third-party material included in their submission.
3. Significant third-party, proprietary, licensed, or open-source components shall be disclosed clearly

5. Evaluation and Selection

1. Submissions shall be evaluated by committees or juries appointed by the organizers in accordance with the applicable problem statement and evaluation criteria.
2. Evaluation may include review of written submissions, software, source code, simulation results, technical evidence, presentations, demonstrations, and viva voce.
3. Shortlisting or selection at any stage does not guarantee progression to any subsequent stage.
4. The number of shortlisted or winning teams specified in Challenge documents represents the maximum number that may be selected. The organizers are not obligated to fill all available positions if submissions do not meet the required standard.
5. The decision of the designated Evaluation Committee regarding technical evaluation and selection shall be final, subject to any review procedure expressly provided by the organizers.
6. The organizers are not required to provide detailed individual evaluation reports to every participant.

6. Financial Support, Rewards, and Reimbursements

1. Financial support, rewards, travel assistance, accommodation support shall be provided only where expressly specified and approved under the Challenge.
2. Release of financial support may be subject to submission of required administrative, banking, institutional, utilization, or supporting documents.
3. Challenge funding shall be used only for purposes reasonably related to the Challenge and in accordance with any funding guidelines issued by the organizers.
4. Participants shall be responsible for maintaining required records of expenditure where such records are prescribed.
5. Travel and accommodation support, where provided, shall be governed by applicable IIT Bombay, IISERB and VJTI norms and approved budget limits.
6. Any prize, grant, support, or reimbursement may be subject to applicable statutory deductions, taxation, and administrative requirements.
7. Receipt of Challenge funding, support, mentoring, or awards shall not, by itself, create an employment relationship, joint venture, partnership, or transfer of intellectual-property ownership.

7. Intellectual Property – Background IP

1. Any intellectual property developed, owned, or lawfully licensed by a participant before participation in the Challenge, or developed independently of the Challenge ("Background IP"), shall remain the property of its existing owner.
2. Participation in the Challenge shall not, by itself, transfer ownership of any Background IP to the Host and Collaborating Institutes.
3. Participants shall, wherever reasonably possible, identify significant Background IP, third-party intellectual property, or proprietary technology incorporated into their submissions.

8. Intellectual Property Developed During the Challenge

1. Intellectual property created solely by a participant or team during the Challenge, without substantive inventive or developmental contribution from the Host and the Collaborating Institute, shall remain owned by the participant or team.

2. Where intellectual property is created jointly through substantive intellectual or inventive contributions from both the participant(s) and personnel of the Host and the Collaborating Institutes, ownership shall be determined in accordance with:
 - the applicable Intellectual Property Policy of the Host and the Collaborating Institute; and
 - the respective contributions of the parties.
3. Provision of Challenge funding, access to facilities, evaluation, general mentoring, administrative support, or routine technical guidance shall not, by itself, constitute joint inventorship or joint ownership.

9. Rights Granted to the Host & the Collaborating Institutes

1. Participants grant the Host & the Collaborating Institutes a non-exclusive, royalty-free licence to use submitted materials to the extent reasonably necessary for:
 - administration and evaluation of the Challenge;
 - verification and reproduction of submitted results;
 - reporting to the funding agency and authorized stakeholders;
 - academic and research purposes; and
 - documentation and promotion of the Challenge.
2. This licence shall not authorize the Host & the Collaborating Institutes to commercially exploit, license to third parties, or publicly distribute confidential technical information, proprietary source code, detailed CAD/design files, trade secrets, or patentable information without prior consent of the relevant participant(s), except where required by law or applicable funding conditions.
3. The Host & the Collaborating Institutes may use team names, project titles, approved non-confidential descriptions, photographs, videos, and other materials provided or approved for Challenge publicity.

10. Rights of Participants

Participants shall retain the right to further develop, research, publish, license, commercialize, incubate, or otherwise exploit intellectual property owned by them, subject to:

- third-party rights;
- jointly owned intellectual property;
- confidentiality obligations; and
- any separate agreement entered into for subsequent funded development.

Participation in the Challenge shall not restrict a participant from independently continuing work in the same technical area.

11. Confidentiality and Public Disclosure

1. Participants may clearly identify specific portions of their submissions as:
Confidential / Proprietary / Potentially Patentable
2. Such information shall be handled with reasonable confidentiality by the organizers and evaluators, subject to applicable law and Challenge requirements.
3. Participants are responsible for identifying potentially patentable subject matter before public presentation, demonstration, exhibition, publication, or media disclosure.
4. Participants should avoid including unnecessary confidential or commercially sensitive information in publicly accessible presentations, promotional material, or demonstrations.
5. Public disclosure of confidential or potentially patentable information should be coordinated, where applicable, with the relevant intellectual-property owner so that opportunities for protection are not unnecessarily prejudiced.

12. Safety, Legal, and Regulatory Compliance

1. Participants shall comply with all applicable laws, regulations, institutional rules, safety requirements, and technical restrictions relevant to their activities.

2. Participants shall not undertake unsafe UAV operations, unauthorized flight testing, unauthorized access to systems or networks, or any other activity prohibited by law.
3. Any flight, hardware, cybersecurity, radio-frequency, experimental, or field-testing activity shall be carried out only in accordance with applicable regulatory and institutional requirements.
4. The organizers may suspend or stop any activity considered unsafe, unauthorized, or inconsistent with Challenge requirements.

13. Conduct

Participants shall maintain professional and respectful conduct throughout the Challenge.

Participants shall not engage in:

- harassment or misconduct;
- deliberate interference with another team;
- plagiarism;
- falsification or fabrication;
- unauthorized access to systems or data;
- breach of confidentiality;
- unsafe conduct; or
- deliberate violation of Challenge rules.

14. Disqualification

The organizers may disqualify a participant or team for reasons including:

- failure to meet eligibility requirements;
- providing false or materially misleading information;
- plagiarism or infringement of third-party rights;
- fabrication or falsification of technical results;
- serious breach of confidentiality;
- serious safety or legal violations;
- failure to comply with required submissions or evaluation activities;
- unauthorized change or misrepresentation of team members;
- deliberate interference with the Challenge or other participants; or
- material breach of these Terms and Conditions.

Where appropriate, the organizers may seek clarification from the concerned team before taking a final decision.

15. Withdrawal

1. A team may withdraw from the Challenge by notifying the organizers through the designated communication channel.
2. Withdrawal shall not extinguish obligations already incurred relating to:
 - confidentiality;
 - intellectual property;
 - utilization of financial support;
 - reporting requirements; or
 - third-party rights.
3. Treatment of any unutilized or improperly utilized funds following withdrawal shall be governed by the applicable funding guidelines.

16. Post-Challenge Development

1. Selected teams may be considered for further funding, mentoring, incubation, prototype development, testing, or access to facilities after completion of the Challenge.
2. Selection as a finalist or winner shall not automatically create an entitlement to such support.
3. Participation in any post-Challenge development programme may be subject to a separate agreement.

4. Before substantial jointly supported development begins, the concerned parties may agree on:
 - Background IP;
 - scope of development work;
 - ownership of newly generated IP;
 - access and usage rights;
 - licensing and commercialization arrangements;
 - responsibility for IP protection; and
 - revenue-sharing or technology-transfer arrangements.
5. Intellectual property generated during subsequent jointly supported work shall be governed by the applicable Host & Collaborating Institutes Intellectual Property Policy and the relevant executed agreement.

17. Publicity and Documentation

1. The organizers may photograph, record, or document Challenge activities.
2. Team names, project titles, non-confidential project descriptions, photographs, videos, and approved materials may be used for:
 - Challenge reports;
 - websites and social media;
 - institutional or government reporting;
 - outreach and promotional activities; and
 - documentation of the Challenge.
3. Confidential technical information shall remain subject to the confidentiality provisions stated above.

18. Participant Costs and Property

1. Except for support specifically approved under the Challenge, participants shall bear their own costs of participation.
2. Participants remain responsible for their own equipment, prototypes, computers, tools, and other property brought to Challenge venues.
3. Use of Host Institute facilities or equipment shall be subject to applicable institutional rules.

19. Changes to Challenge Arrangements

The organizers may reasonably modify:

- schedules and deadlines;
- submission procedures;
- venue or evaluation arrangements;
- administrative requirements;
- technical clarifications; or
- Challenge activities,

where necessary due to technical, administrative, safety, regulatory, funding, or other circumstances. Material changes shall be communicated through official Challenge channels.

20. Relationship with Other Challenge Documents

1. These Terms and Conditions shall be read together with the applicable:
 - Problem Statement;
 - submission instructions;
 - funding guidelines;
 - travel guidelines; and
 - official written clarifications issued by the organizers.
2. Technical requirements, deliverables, schedules, and evaluation criteria specific to each Challenge shall be governed by the corresponding Problem Statement.

3. Where any intellectual-property matter is not expressly addressed in these Terms and Conditions, the applicable Intellectual Property Policy of the Host & the Collaborating Institutes shall govern.
4. Where a separately executed research, funding, incubation, prototype-development, technology-transfer, or intellectual-property agreement applies, that agreement shall prevail for the activities covered by it.

21. Official Communication

1. Participants are responsible for monitoring the official communication channels specified by the organizers.
2. Official notices, clarifications, schedules, results, and instructions communicated through such channels shall form part of the Challenge administration.
3. Participants are responsible for keeping their registered contact information current.

22. Participant Declaration

By registering for or participating in the PUSHPAK Grand Challenge 2026, the participant confirms that:

1. They have read and understood these Terms and Conditions and the applicable Problem Statement;
2. Information provided during registration is accurate;
3. they have the necessary authority and permissions to submit the materials included in their entry;
4. Their submission does not infringe third-party intellectual-property rights;
5. Relevant Background IP, third-party IP, licensed material, and restricted components will be disclosed where required;
6. They accept the applicable evaluation and selection process;
7. They shall comply with the applicable safety, legal, technical, confidentiality, and administrative requirements; and
8. Where participation is through a team or organization, the person completing the registration is authorized to accept these Terms and Conditions on its behalf.

23. The Participant shall indemnify, defend and keep indemnified the Host & the Collaborating Institutes, its officers, employees, faculty, staff, evaluators, mentors, volunteers and representatives (collectively, the “Indemnified Parties”) from and against any and all claims, demands, actions, proceedings, losses, damages, liabilities, penalties, costs and expenses (including reasonable legal expenses) arising out of or relating to:

- (a) Any breach by the Participant or its team members of these Terms and Conditions, the applicable Problem Statement or any applicable law, regulation or institutional requirement;
- (b) Any allegation or claim that the Participant's submission, materials, technology, software, data, content or other materials infringe or misappropriate any third-party intellectual property or other proprietary rights;
- (c) Any unauthorized use or disclosure of third-party or confidential information by the Participant;
- (d) Any injury, loss or damage caused by the Participant, its team members, representatives, equipment, prototype, software or other activities in connection with the Challenge, except to the extent caused by the negligence or wilful misconduct of the relevant Indemnified Party; and

(e) Any claim arising from the Participant's use of any third-party software, hardware, data, technology, services or other materials.

24. The Participant shall not use the name, logo, emblem, trademark or other institutional marks of the Host and the Collaborating Institutes, including “IIT Bombay” or “IITB”, “IISERB” and “VJTI” in any manner without the prior written consent of the Host & the Collaborating Institutes. Participation in or selection for the Challenge shall not imply any endorsement or affiliation by the Host & the Collaborating Institutes.

25. These Terms and Conditions shall be governed by the laws of India, and any dispute arising out of or in connection with the Challenge shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts at Mumbai, Maharashtra.

By proceeding with registration or participation, the participant agrees to be bound by these Terms and Conditions.

Team ID:

Name & Signature of Team Lead:

Name & Signature of Member 1:

Name & Signature of Member 3:

Name & Signature of Member 2:

Name & Signature of Member 4: